International Business Development Program

Spring Semester 2026
General Information Session

September 17, 2025

IBD BerkeleyHaas
International Business Development

Who We Are

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Agenda

September 17, 2025

- What is the IBD program?
- IBD Mechanics
- Enrolling in IBD
- What to Expect in IBD
- Q&A

BerkeleyHaas

What is IBD?

- Management consulting elective course
- International projects with real world clients
- Offered to MBAs at Berkeley Haas for 34 years!

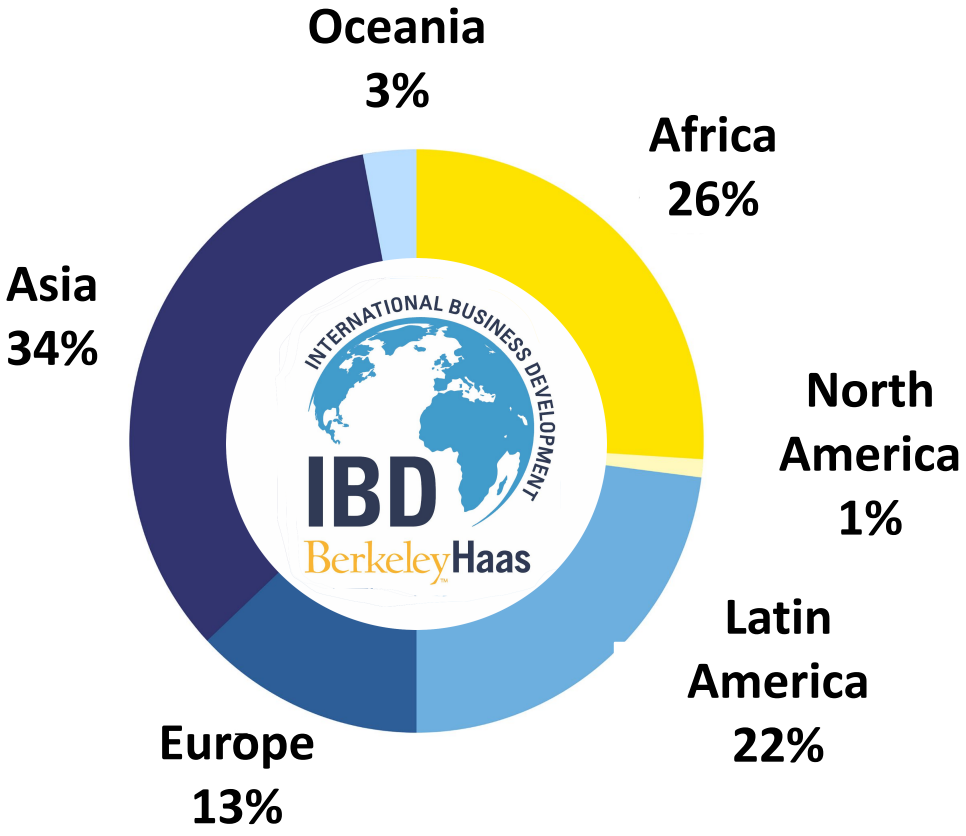
1,800+ MBA Students

500+ Global Projects

89 Countries



IBD Projects
1992-2025



Where does IBD work?

Spring 2026 IBD Program Class

- 3 Unit Elective FTMBA Course
- Remote collaboration with clients from January to early-May
- 2 weeks of project work overseas in late-May
- First year FTMBA students only
- 9:00 am-12:00 pm on Thursdays
- IBD is a No-Drop Course!

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How does the IBD Program work?

- **Oct 8**: IBD application deadline
  - All applicants will be considered for a team member position
  - Those interested in being a team lead indicate this on the application

- **Week of Oct 13**: Review of IBD applications and selected team lead candidate interviews

- **Week of Oct 27**: Notification of acceptance into the IBD program

- **Spring semester**:
  - All enrolled students are assigned to a project team advised by a Faculty Mentor
  - Each team has 4 members (including a Team Lead) and 1 Faculty Mentor
  - Teams spend last 2 weeks of May in-country

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Team Member & Team Lead Expectations

Team Member Expectations

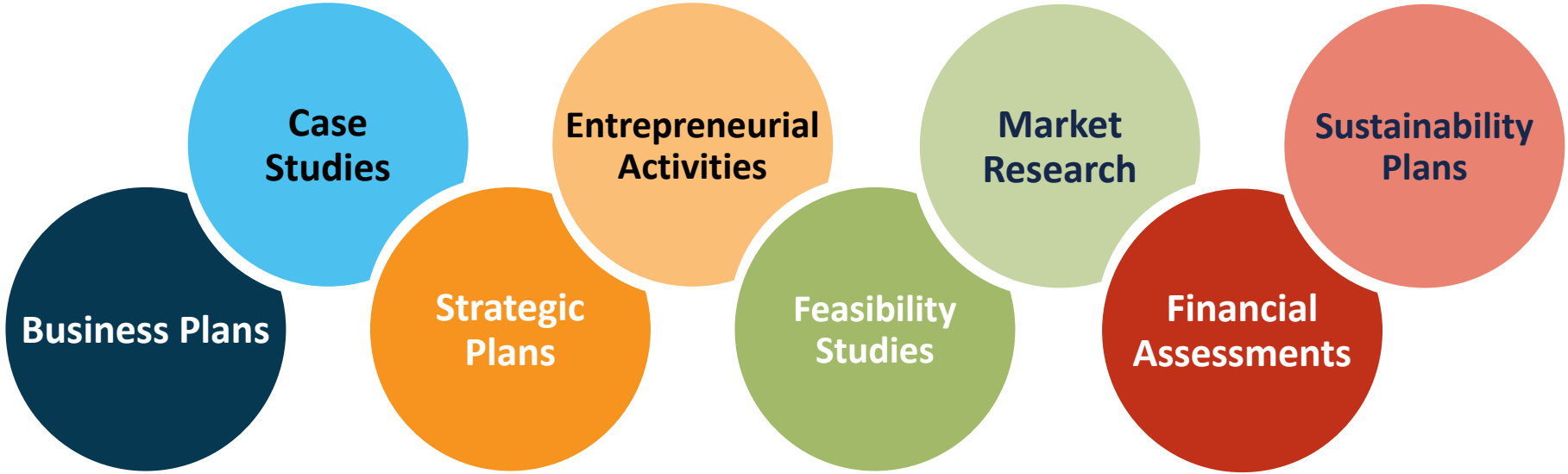
- 8-10 hours/week (including class time and client calls)
- Timely, high quality output
- Engagement throughout the semester and project
- Completion of all client-related tasks
- Cooperation with team lead and members
- Support of team members in improving their work products

Team Lead Expectations

- 10-12 hours/week
- Effective team schedule creation and progress management
- Assurance of on-time completion of project tasks and assignments
- Best practices coaching of team members
- Effective communication with team, faculty mentor, IBD staff, and clients
- Coordination of team travel logistics with IBD staff and clients
- New this year! 1 additional unit

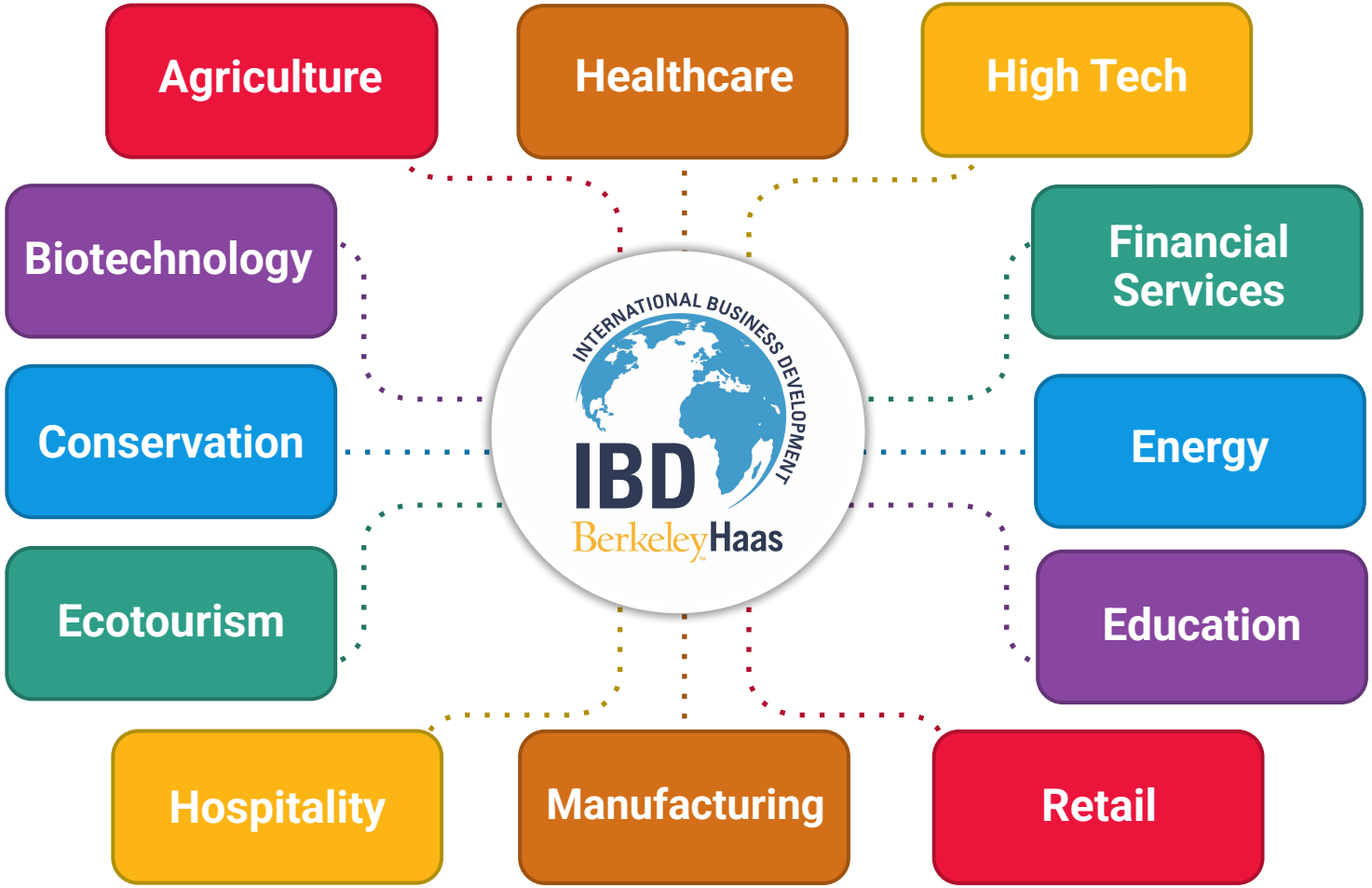
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IBD projects include diverse components



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Clients come from many sectors



Clients include big brands and startups



















































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“They captured very well the essence of what was sought with this project: they interviewed the patients and collaborators of Visualiza in the communities; they realized the value proposition, the segmentation and the marketing strategy accordingly for the region. ***I can tell you that the results provided by the IBD team exceeded the expectations – really the team did an amazing job!”***

Visualiza, Guatemala



“The IBD student team had an exceptional understanding of our business profile and project scope, despite the limited time they had in-country.” ***BRF, Singapore***



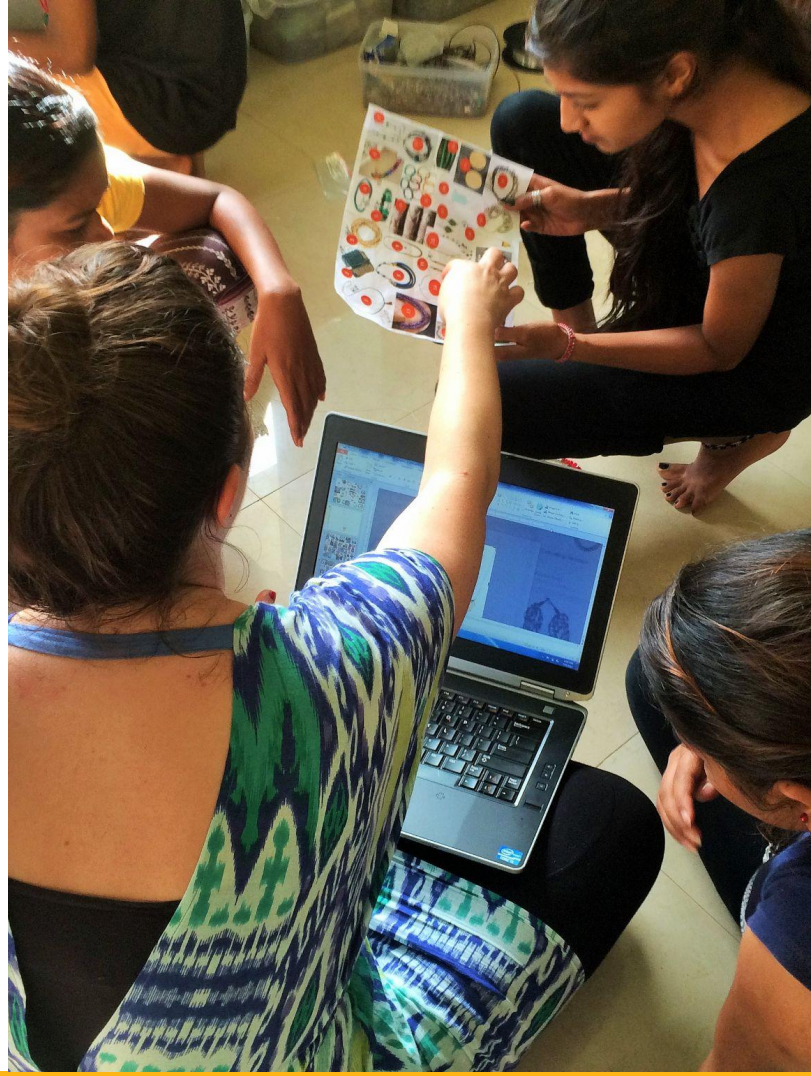
What content is covered in IBD?

IBD course content is customized based on the project mix and includes:

- Project scope and client management tools
- Problem definition, hypothesis development and testing
- Market research and analysis, including primary research (qual and/or quant)
- Tools for development of GTM, strategic planning, and assessing product-market fit

Who are the best IBD student candidates?

- Flexible!
- Open minded
- Hard working
- Team-oriented
- Able to deal with ambiguity



How to sign up for Spring 2026 IBD?

- **Mid-September:** IBD application sent to all first years
- **Early October**:
  - Oct 8: Applications due; reviewed by IBD faculty and staff
  - Mid-month: Team lead applicant interviews
- **Late October:** Notification of admission to 2026 IBD program
- **Be aware:**
  - **IBD is a no-drop class!**
  - All students enrolling in the 2026 IBD program will have 333 elective points deducted in the Spring Semester and 80 points deducted in the following Fall Semester for a total of 413 elective points

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How are students assigned to an IBD team and project?

- As part of the application, we ask if there are project locations you are not able to travel to
- Faculty mentors use this information and assign students to project teams based on alignment between client needs and student experience and interests
- All projects are revealed in class on the first class session on Thursday, January 22

What is the IBD course schedule?

Jan 22
First class session, 9-12 pm

May 7
Last class session

May 18-30
Teams work on site in-country. This is not flexible and students must be in-country the entire time

Mid-September
Half-day Fall Conference when teams present their IBD projects to classmates and guests

How does the IBD Project Travel work?

Overseas student travel for 2 weeks in May is a critical part of the IBD academic and project experience

- IBD works with Berkeley Study Abroad Office to obtain campus approval for all IBD overseas student travel
- Participants will be required to sign an IBD Code of Conduct as part of the application process
- If IBD project travel is cancelled due to unforeseen circumstances, students will continue to work remotely to wrap up the project during those 2 weeks in May

Who Pays for What?

- The costs of student flights and accommodations are covered by IBD and the project clients
- Students work with UC Travel to reserve flights
- Students are responsible for their in-country meals and entertainment, as well as visas and vaccinations

What about IBD Project Travel and Vaccinations ?

- You are required to enroll in UC Travel Insurance when traveling overseas: https://www.ucop.edu/risk-services-travel/
- Countries may require proof of vaccinations for you to enter the country, as well as to obtain an entry visa if necessary
- If you get sick and/or test positive for COVID while overseas, we will work with you and your project client to ensure that you have access to care as needed

Attention: International Students

International Students are advised to contact the Berkeley International Office (BIO) **before completing an application for the IBD program** to ensure that all requirements can be met for international project travel in May

Please note that international students may have additional document requirements when traveling outside the U.S., such as visa, passport, re-entry or other requirements

Attention: Scholarship Students

Some scholarship programs have restrictions on international travel for students while they are in the U.S.

If you have received a scholarship (or scholarships), please review your scholarship guidelines before applying for the IBD program to ensure that you are allowed to travel overseas in May as part of a university program such as IBD

Dion Watts
DK Kim Foundation
Tanzania

Julia Conte
SeamlessHR
Kenya

Roshan Ravikumar
Passione Beauty
Italy

Sarah Danson
Jospak
Finland

Jeffrey Dagadu
EBANX
Brazil

IBD on the Web

- Check out the IBD website for more information about the program: https://haas.berkeley.edu/ibd

- And make sure to visit the IBD blog for more student insights into the IBD overseas experience: https://haas.berkeley.edu/international-business-development/blog/



Thank you for joining us!

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